

IT Admin Handbook

Complete reference · Beta 1.0 · June 2026

HQHB · SignFlow — IT Admin Handbook

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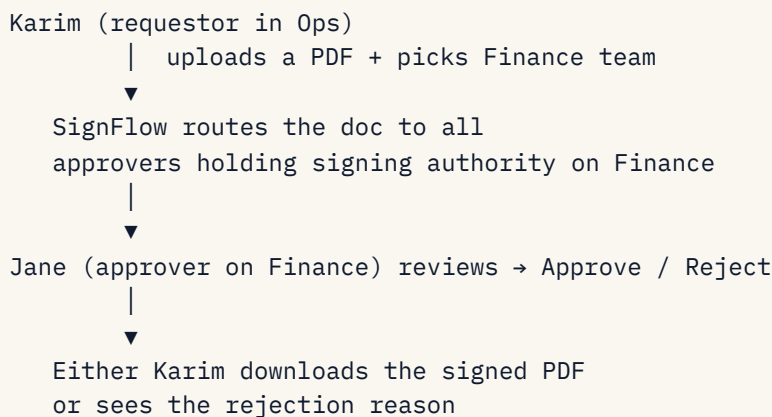
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1. The big picture

SignFlow handles three primary roles. Every user is one of these:

ROLE	WHAT THEY DO
Requestor	Uploads a document, picks who needs to sign it, submits it. Belongs to one team (their department).
Approver	Receives requests routed to them. Reviews, then either signs (approves) or rejects with a reason. Holds <i>signing authority</i> over one or more teams.
Admin	You. Sets up the org — teams, users, signatures. Sees everything.

A typical request flow:



There are two flavours of routing:

- **Single approver** — *any* approver on the target team can sign. First one wins. Useful for routine docs.
- **Multi-step workflow** — *specific* people across one or more teams sign *in order*. Step 1 must complete before Step 2 starts. Useful for sign-off chains (e.g. Manager → Director → CFO).

2. Your admin dashboard

Sign in at the URL above with your admin credentials. You land on the **Administration** home with six tiles:

TILE	WHAT IT DOES
Onboard team	The fastest way to add a whole team at once — pick (or create) the team, upload an Excel/CSV of members, choose roles, send welcome emails.
Users	The master user list with passwords visible, reset / invite buttons, mobile-friendly cards.
Teams & authority	Create teams, edit who's an approver vs member, jump to that team's documents.
Signatures	Upload signatures in bulk on behalf of users (by email filename).
All documents	Every request in the system. Filter by team + status. Download or print any file.
Reports	Team-wise totals, top approvers, CSV export.
Email log	Every email SignFlow has ever tried to send — useful when SendGrid isn't configured.

The top nav also gives you a **Password** button (change your own password) and **Add signature** (your own signature, used if you ever sign as an admin).

3. Onboarding a team end-to-end

The recommended new-team flow:

Step 1 — Send the onboarding form

Use the file `docs/onboarding-form.csv` (open in Google Sheets and share with the department head). They fill in:

- Team name
- Department head's name + email (will be **approver**)
- Members' names + emails (will be **requestors**)

Step 2 — Open Admin → Onboard team

A 4-step wizard:

Step 1 · TEAM	Step 2 · UPLOAD	Step 3 · REVIEW	Step 4 · DONE
☒ Existing team	Choose file →	☒ Send welcome	✓ X created
☐ Create new	(xlsx or csv)	emails	✓ Y invites sent
[pick / type name]	OR Add row manually		
	OR Download template		

Step 3 — Get the import file

On step 2 you have three options:

- **Download template** — gets you `team-members-template.xlsx` with the exact columns. Fill in your data, save, then **Choose file** to upload.
- **Choose file** — upload your Excel/CSV directly.
- **Add row manually** — for small teams, type rows in-line.

Required columns: `name` , `email` . **Optional:** `role` (defaults to `requestor` ; set to `approver` to make someone a signer for this team).

Step 4 — Review + send

On Step 3:

- See the parsed list, edit any row if needed
- Toggle "**Send welcome emails with credentials**" (default ON)
- Click **Create users & send invites**

Step 5 — Confirmation

Step 4 shows you which users were created and how many invite emails went out. Any failures are listed individually so you can fix them.

Important: the welcome email contains the generated password. The user signs in with it, then changes it from the top nav. Admins never need to know the password — but it's also stored on the user record (visible to you on the Users page) so you can share manually if SendGrid isn't delivering.

4. Managing individual users

Admin → **Users**.

What you see per user

COLUMN	MEANING
Name	Their full name. A small  next to it means they've registered a signature.
Email	Sign-in identifier.
Role	requestor / approver / admin pill.
Team / Authority	For a requestor, their department. For an approver, the teams they can sign for.
Password	Current password, masked.  reveal ,  copy , auto-refreshed every 20s.
Actions	 send invite,  reset password,  delete.

The page **auto-refreshes every 20 seconds** so when a user changes their own password from another browser, you see the new value within 20s. Manual **Refresh** button in the toolbar forces it immediately.

Adding a single user

Click **Add user** → a 3-step wizard:

1. **Identity** — name, email, password
2. **Role & assignment** — pick requestor / approver / admin. Approvers pick signing authority teams; requestors pick a department.
3. **Confirm** — review and create.

Bulk-uploading users

Click **Bulk upload CSV** for the legacy CSV format. (Most of the time, **Onboard team** is the better path.)

Sending or resending a welcome email

Click the  **Mail** icon on any non-admin row. A new random password is generated, hashed, and emailed using the welcome template.

Resetting a password

Click the  **Key** icon. A modal opens:

Reset password

Jane Doe

jane@hqhb.in

NEW PASSWORD

[_____]



Empty → auto-generate.

[Cancel] [Generate & email]

- Leave blank → server generates a secure random one.
- Or type whatever you want → it's set exactly as typed.
- Click submit → user gets an email titled *"Your HQHB SignFlow password has been reset"*.

Deleting a user

Trash icon. A confirmation modal explains:

- Their name is replaced by "(deleted user)" on past requests.
- Documents stay intact.
- In-flight workflows where they were a pending signer need to be re-routed.

5. Managing teams and signing authority

Admin → **Teams & authority**.

Creating a team

Type a name in the top field, click **Add team**.

Editing membership

Each team card has two editable sections:

Approvers — who can sign documents routed to this team.

- **+ Add** → picker of any approver not yet on this team. Click → granted instantly.
- **X** on a row → revokes that approver's authority (with confirmation).

Department members — requestors whose department is this team.

- **+ Add** → picker of any requestor not in this team (shows their current team if any).
- **X** on a row → removes them (with confirmation). They become teamless until reassigned.

Viewing a team's documents

Documents button in the card header → opens the Documents view pre-filtered to that team only.

Deleting a team

in the card header → confirmation. Approvers lose authority, members are unassigned. Past requests stay intact.

6. Passwords

How they work

Two things are stored for every user:

- `password_hash` — bcrypt hash used to authenticate sign-in.
- `last_temp_password` — the current plaintext, visible to admins only on the Users page.

The plaintext is updated **every time** the password changes:

- Admin creates a user
- Admin sends invite / resets password
- User clicks **Forgot password?** on login
- User changes their own password from the top nav

Where to see a password

Admin → **Users** → Password column. Click  to reveal,  to copy.

Self-service: when a user changes their own password

They click the **Password** button (top nav) → modal asks for current + new password (twice). Server verifies the current password against the hash; if correct, both columns update. Your Users page reflects it within 20s.

Self-service: when they've forgotten

Login screen → **Forgot password?** → they enter their email. Server generates a new random password and emails it. (Returns generic success even if email doesn't exist — prevents account enumeration.)

Sharing credentials manually

If SendGrid isn't configured / a user can't reach their email, you can simply:

1. Click  on their row.
2. Either let it generate, or type the password you want.
3. After the modal closes, the row auto-reveals the password.
4. Click  to copy it.
5. Share via WhatsApp / Signal / in person.

7. Signatures

Admin → **Signatures**.

Every requestor and approver **must register a signature on first sign-in** — they're prompted with a draw / upload modal. Approvers can't act on requests without one.

Uploading on someone's behalf

Two sub-sections:

- **Without signature** — lists everyone who hasn't registered yet. Click **Add** → draws/upload modal for them. Save → it's set.
- **On file** — everyone who has. Hover for **Replace**.

Bulk-upload signatures

Click **Bulk upload** → upload PNG / JPG files **named as the user's email**, e.g.

`karim.ops@hqhb.in.png` . SignFlow matches each filename to its user and assigns.

Why this matters

A signature image is what gets stamped onto signed PDFs. SignFlow also records the image's native aspect ratio so the marker boxes on documents snap to the right shape — what the requestor draws is what the approver actually stamps.

8. Documents and audit

Admin → **All documents**.

Every request lives here, regardless of who submitted it or where it stands.

Filters

- **Team** picker at top — `All teams` or a specific team. Shows team-wise totals on the right.
- **Status pills** — `all / pending / approved / rejected` . Each shows its count.

Per-document actions

- **Download** — gets the file. For PDFs that have been signed, you get the **signed** version (with stamps).
- **Print** — opens a print dialog for either PDF or Excel.

Auditing

Click on any row to drill into the workflow timeline, signers, and timestamps. Nothing is hidden from admin.

Reaching team docs faster

Admin → **Teams & authority** → click **Documents** on any team card → goes straight to this view, pre-filtered.

9. Reports

Admin → **Reports**.

Team-wise table

For each team:

METRIC	WHAT IT MEANS
Total	Every document ever routed to this team.
Pending	Awaiting signature. The "(in window)" sub-count = approved-but-not-finalised (still within the 1-hour cooling-off window).
Approved	Final state.
Rejected	With reason, visible on the document detail.

Top approvers

Below the table — every approver and how many documents they've signed / rejected. Useful for load-balancing.

CSV export

Download full CSV in the top-right. Includes every request with every field, ready for Excel / Sheets.

10. Email log

Admin → **Email log**.

Every notification SignFlow tries to send is recorded here, whether or not SendGrid is configured.

Status pills

- **delivered** (green) — SendGrid accepted and sent.
- **failed** (red) — SendGrid rejected. Error text on the row.
- **logged** (amber) — No SendGrid key set. Email body is here only.

Templates

You'll see these names:

TEMPLATE	WHEN
<code>new_request</code>	Requestor submits → notifies the approver.
<code>approved</code>	Doc is finalised → notifies the requestor.
<code>rejected</code>	Doc is rejected → notifies the requestor with reason.
<code>reminder</code>	Requestor sends a reminder → notifies the approver.
<code>welcome</code>	New user created → contains credentials.
<code>reset_password</code>	Admin or self-service reset → contains new password.

When SendGrid isn't configured

If you don't see `SENDGRID_API_KEY` on the server, emails are still recorded here but never actually sent. **Open the email row → the body contains the password.** Use this to share credentials manually.

Configuring SendGrid (when ready)

Set `SENDGRID_API_KEY` and `SENDGRID_FROM_EMAIL` in `server/.env` and restart. From the next minute onwards, every email is real.

11. Daily admin checklist

A 5-minute morning routine:

- ☐ **Email log** — any `failed` entries from yesterday? Investigate.
- ☐ **Users page** — any new users created overnight without a signature? Nudge them.
- ☐ **Reports** — pending count up significantly? Approvers might need a nudge.
- ☐ **Email log → look for `reminder`** entries — pattern of repeated reminders means an approver is unresponsive.

A weekly routine:

- ☐ **Reports → Top approvers** — load distribution OK?
 - ☐ **Download full CSV** for safekeeping.
 - ☐ **Email log** — clear out very old `logged` -only entries if DB is growing.
-

12. Troubleshooting

"User can't sign in"

1. Admin → Users → find them → click  to reveal their password. Tell them.
2. Or click  to reset. Type a fresh password. Share via WhatsApp/Signal.
3. Ask them to clear the browser cache or use an incognito window if still failing.

"Approver doesn't see new requests"

- Confirm they have **signing authority** on the target team: Admin → Teams & authority → that team's card → are they listed under **Approvers**?
- If not: Add them.

"Request submitted but not visible to anyone"

- Check the workflow on the request — Admin → All documents → click the row.
- If a workflow step has an inactive signer (deleted user, no signature), the workflow can stall.

"Mobile shows error opening a PDF"

- Hard refresh (Ctrl+Shift+R or pull-down).
- 63+ page PDFs lazy-load; first open just shows placeholders that fill in as you scroll. Look at the "X / Y loaded" indicator at the top.
- If it says **Could not render PDF** with an error message — copy that exact text and reach out.

"I broke something"

Every change is in Git. Pushed to UAT and master after each commit. Roll back via:

```
git log --oneline  
git revert <commit>
```

Or worst case, contact the developer team.

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